



Signal CEO resigns

WhatsApp co-founder Brian Acton will be interim CEO of Signal after Moxie Marlinspike steps down. <https://digit.in/feb22-23>



Exynos 2200 launch postponed

Renowned leaker Ice Universe stated that Samsung may push back the Exynos 2200 launch date. <https://digit.in/feb22-24>

Don't you Remember?



Find out how and where memories are stored in the human brain

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"Memory is the glue that binds our mental life, the scaffolding that holds our personal history and that makes it possible to grow and change throughout life."

- Larry R. Squire and Eric R. Kandel

WHAT IS MEMORY?

Memory. We perhaps know it by many different names – remembrance, reminiscence, retrospection, souvenirs, and so on.

All human cognitive and motor skills are dependent on memories. They are the means by which we retain and use the information we absorb from the world around us to be able to adapt to and survive in it. They are the threads which connect our past, present, and future selves. One's memories therefore, are integral determinants

of one's personality. However, have you ever wondered just how they're actually stored or retrieved? Like other parts of the brain, each responsible for a specific function?

MEMORIES: ALL THE SAME?

The brain is believed to be the most complex organ in the human body. It comprises millions of interconnected cells referred to as neurons. However, contrary to what one may believe, memories are simultaneously stored in different parts of the brain depending upon their type.

For years, the classification of memories has been a hotly debated topic amongst researchers. However, the most commonly agreed upon classification of memory is that it is of three types – Sensory, Short term and Long term memory.

SENSORY MEMORY

Sensory memory refers to sensory information that is retained once a stimulus has ended. The information is withheld only for a short dura-

tion following which they are transferred to other portions of the brain where long term memories are stored. Sensory memory is divided into subtypes referred to as sensory registers: Iconic or visual memory, such as seeing an aircraft flying overhead, Echoic or auditory memory such as the bark of a dog, Haptic or tactile memory such as being poked by a sharp object, and so on. Two more commonly occurring types of sensory memory are olfactory (smell) and gustatory (taste) memories.

SHORT TERM/WORKING MEMORY

Short term memory is also referred to as working memory. It is stored in the Prefrontal Cortex of the brain, which is a part of the Neocortex and is located at the very front of the brain. Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) shows that the PFC becomes active when people perform tasks which require them to withhold information in their short term memory. As per George Armitage's "The Magical Number Seven, Plus or Minus Two: Some Limits on Our Capacity for Processing Information," one of the most influential and widely cited papers in the field of psychology, the human working memory at any given time, can retain seven items, give or take two. Informa-

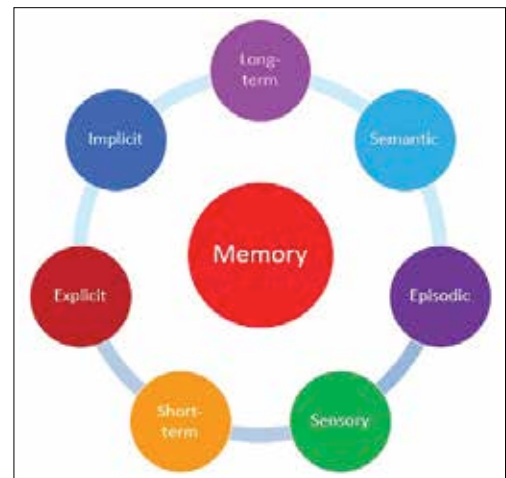


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